

Compare & Contrast

Grade 3 Reading Comprehension Worksheet

Read each pair. Then answer the question.

Dogs and Cats

Dogs love to play fetch and go for long walks. They bark when someone knocks at the door. Most dogs are happy to meet new people.

Cats love to nap in sunny spots and chase toy mice. They purr when they are happy. Most cats hide when new people visit.

1. How are dogs and cats alike?
 - a. They both bark at the door.
 - b. They are both pets that people love.
 - c. They both love long walks.

Summer and Winter

In summer the sun rises early and the days feel long. Children swim in pools and eat cold ice cream to stay cool.

In winter the sun sets early and the days feel short. Children build snowmen and drink hot cocoa to stay warm.

2. How are summer and winter alike?
 - a. Both seasons change how children play and dress.
 - b. Both seasons are hot.
 - c. Children swim in both seasons.

Apples and Oranges

Apples are round fruits that grow on trees in cool places. They are crunchy and come in red, green, and yellow.

Oranges are round fruits that grow on trees in warm places. They are juicy and you peel the thick skin before eating.

3. How are apples and oranges alike?
 - a. They are both round fruits that grow on trees.
 - b. They both have thick peels.
 - c. They both grow in cool places.

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Bikes and Scooters

A bike has two wheels and pedals. You sit on the seat and push the pedals to make the wheels turn.

A scooter has two wheels and a flat board. You stand on the board and push with one foot to move.

1. How are bikes and scooters different?
 - a. A scooter has pedals and a bike does not.
 - b. You pedal a bike sitting down; you push a scooter standing up.
 - c. Bikes have three wheels.

Bees and Butterflies

Bees fly from flower to flower to drink nectar. They carry pollen on their legs, which helps plants grow.

Butterflies fly from flower to flower to drink nectar. Their bright wings have tiny scales that rub off like dust.

2. How are bees and butterflies different?
 - a. Bees carry pollen on their legs; butterflies have scaly wings.
 - b. Butterflies carry pollen on their legs.
 - c. Bees have bright wings.

Lakes and Oceans

A lake is a large body of water with land all around it. Lake water is usually fresh, not salty.

An ocean is a huge body of salty water. Oceans are much deeper and bigger than lakes, with waves and tides.

3. How are lakes and oceans different?
 - a. Lakes are bigger than oceans.
 - b. Lakes have fresh water; oceans have salty water.
 - c. Oceans have fresh water.

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Trains and Airplanes

Trains run on tracks on the ground. They can carry many people and heavy loads across the country.

Airplanes fly high in the sky. They carry people across the country much faster than trains.

1. How are trains and airplanes alike?
 - a. They both fly.
 - b. They both carry people across long distances.
 - c. They both run on tracks.

Frogs and Fish

Frogs begin life in water as tadpoles, then grow legs and hop on land. Adult frogs can live both in water and on land.

Fish live in water their whole lives. They breathe through gills and swim with fins and tails.

2. How are frogs and fish alike?
 - a. They both breathe through gills.
 - b. They both begin life in the water.
 - c. They both hop on land.

Libraries and Bookstores

At a library you can borrow books for free. You must bring the books back by the date stamped inside.

At a bookstore you buy books to keep. Once you pay, the book is yours to keep forever.

3. How are libraries and bookstores alike?
 - a. You pay for books at both.
 - b. You must return books at both.
 - c. They both have many books to choose from.

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Spiders and Insects

Spiders have eight legs and two main body parts. Most spiders spin silk webs to catch food.

Insects have six legs and three main body parts. Many insects, like bees and ants, live in large groups.

1. How are spiders and insects different?
 - a. Spiders have eight legs; insects have six legs.
 - b. Insects have eight legs.
 - c. Spiders have three body parts.

Deserts and Rainforests

Deserts are very dry places with little rain. Cactuses store water in their thick stems to live there.

Rainforests are very wet places with rain almost every day. Tall trees grow close together under the clouds.

2. How are deserts and rainforests different?
 - a. Deserts get almost no rain; rainforests get rain nearly every day.
 - b. Deserts get rain every day.
 - c. Rainforests are dry places.

Pencils and Pens

Pencils write with a gray mark that you can erase. When the tip gets dull, you sharpen it to a point again.

Pens write with ink that you cannot erase. When a pen runs out of ink, you throw it away or refill it.

3. How are pencils and pens different?
 - a. Pencils write with ink.
 - b. Pencil marks can be erased, but pen ink cannot.
 - c. Pen marks can be erased.

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Morning and Night

In the morning the sun rises and the sky grows light. Birds sing and people wake up to start the day.

At night the sun sets and the sky grows dark. Owls hoot and people go to sleep to rest.

1. How are morning and night alike?
 - a. Birds sing at both times.
 - b. People sleep at both times.
 - c. Both are times of day when the sky changes.

Horses and Zebras

Horses are strong animals that people ride. They live on farms and eat hay and grass.

Zebras look like horses with black and white stripes. They live wild in Africa and eat grass.

2. How are horses and zebras alike?
 - a. They are both hoofed animals that eat grass.
 - b. People ride both of them.
 - c. Both have stripes.

Camping and Hotels

When you camp, you sleep in a tent under the stars. You cook food over a fire and hear crickets at night.

When you stay at a hotel, you sleep in a soft bed indoors. You eat in a restaurant and watch TV in your room.

3. How are camping and hotels alike?
 - a. Both have soft beds.
 - b. They are both places to sleep away from home.
 - c. You sleep in a tent at both.

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Rivers and Ponds

A river is water that flows in one direction toward the sea. Fish swim against the moving current.

A pond is still water that does not flow. Frogs and ducks live in the quiet water near the edges.

1. How are rivers and ponds different?
 - a. Rivers never move.
 - b. Pond water flows fast.
 - c. River water flows, but pond water stays still.

Soccer and Basketball

In soccer, players kick a round ball and try to score in a goal. Only the goalie may touch the ball with hands.

In basketball, players bounce a round ball and try to score in a hoop. Players use their hands, not their feet.

2. How are soccer and basketball different?
 - a. Soccer uses a hoop.
 - b. Basketball is played with feet.
 - c. Soccer is played with feet; basketball is played with hands.

Owls and Eagles

Owls hunt at night with big eyes that see in the dark. They fly silently and turn their heads far around.

Eagles hunt in the daytime with sharp eyes that spot prey far below. They soar high on wide wings.

3. How are owls and eagles different?
 - a. Owls hunt at night; eagles hunt in the daytime.
 - b. Eagles hunt at night.
 - c. Owls soar in the daytime.

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Cake and Ice Cream

Cake is baked in an oven until it rises and turns golden. People often cover it with sweet frosting.

Ice cream is frozen in a freezer until it is cold and creamy. People often top it with hot fudge.

1. How are cake and ice cream alike?
 - a. Both are served frozen.
 - b. Both are baked in an oven.
 - c. They are both sweet treats for celebrations.

Newspapers and Storybooks

Newspapers tell about real events that happened today. Reporters write short articles with facts.

Storybooks tell made-up tales about characters. Authors write longer stories that come from imagination.

2. How are newspapers and storybooks alike?
 - a. They both have writing that people read.
 - b. Both tell made-up tales.
 - c. Both tell only true events.

Turtles and Rabbits

Turtles move slowly on short legs and carry a hard shell on their backs. They pull inside the shell to hide.

Rabbits move quickly on strong back legs and have soft fur. They run fast to escape danger.

3. How are turtles and rabbits alike?
 - a. They are both small animals that hide from danger.
 - b. They both have shells.
 - c. They both move quickly.

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Mountains and Hills

Mountains are very tall with steep sides and rocky tops. Snow often covers the highest peaks.

Hills are lower and rounder with gentle slopes. Grass and trees grow easily on hills.

1. How are mountains and hills different?
 - a. Mountains are tall and steep; hills are lower and gentle.
 - b. Hills are taller than mountains.
 - c. Mountains are flat and low.

Ants and Bees

Ants live in underground nests and march in lines to find food. Worker ants carry crumbs much bigger than themselves.

Bees live in hives and fly out to visit flowers. Worker bees carry pollen and make honey.

2. How are ants and bees different?
 - a. Bees march on the ground.
 - b. Ants march on the ground; bees fly through the air.
 - c. Ants fly to flowers.

Gloves and Mittens

Gloves have a separate space for each finger. They help you grip things like bike handles in winter.

Mittens keep all four fingers together in one warm pocket. They are warmer but make gripping harder.

3. How are gloves and mittens different?
 - a. Gloves separate the fingers; mittens keep them together.
 - b. Mittens separate the fingers.
 - c. Gloves keep fingers together.

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Volcanoes and Earthquakes

A volcano erupts when hot melted rock pushes up through the ground. Red lava flows out and hardens into new rock.

An earthquake happens when the ground suddenly shakes. The shaking can crack roads and topple buildings.

1. How are volcanoes and earthquakes alike?
 - a. They are both powerful events caused by movement under the earth.
 - b. Both pour out lava.
 - c. Both shake the ground.

Dolphins and Sharks

Dolphins are mammals that breathe air through a hole on top of their heads. They are playful and swim in groups.

Sharks are fish that breathe through gills on their sides. They swim alone and hunt other sea animals.

2. How are dolphins and sharks alike?
 - a. They both live in the ocean and swim with fins.
 - b. They both breathe through gills.
 - c. They are both mammals.

Crayons and Markers

Crayons are made of wax and draw soft lines. If you press too hard, they can break in half.

Markers are filled with ink and draw bright bold lines. If you leave the cap off, they dry out.

3. How are crayons and markers alike?
 - a. Both are made of wax.
 - b. Both dry out without caps.
 - c. They are both coloring tools that draw lines.

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Spring and Fall

In spring, flowers bloom and baby animals are born. The days grow warmer and rain helps seeds sprout.

In fall, leaves turn red and gold and drop from trees. The days grow cooler and animals gather food.

1. How are spring and fall different?
 - a. Spring brings new growth; fall brings leaves dropping.
 - b. Flowers bloom in fall.
 - c. Leaves drop in spring.

Pianos and Guitars

A piano has black and white keys that you press to make music. It is big and stays in one place.

A guitar has six strings that you pluck or strum to make music. It is small enough to carry anywhere.

2. How are pianos and guitars different?
 - a. Pianos have keys and stay put; guitars have strings and travel.
 - b. Guitars have keys.
 - c. Pianos have six strings.

Whales and Elephants

Whales are the largest animals in the sea. They swim in the ocean and come up to breathe air.

Elephants are the largest animals on land. They walk on the ground and breathe air through trunks and mouths.

3. How are whales and elephants different?
 - a. Whales live in the sea; elephants live on land.
 - b. Elephants live in the sea.
 - c. Whales walk on land.